

Timeline comparison

Date / time	Independently documented or observed event
June 4, 1842	Poe writes from Philadelphia about analyzing the Rogers case through press arguments.
November 1842	First installment of *The Mystery of Marie Rogêt* appears.
Preview, 8:20 p.m.	Quill leaves conservation table carrying Voss's note.
Preview, 8:31 p.m.	Source sees Crane carry the black portfolio toward the pump door.
Preview, 8:44 p.m.	Crane returns without it.
Preview, 9:10 p.m.	Quill is reported missing.

The alleged proof's cave-visit paragraph is dated May 1842 yet calls *The Mystery of Marie Rogêt* 'the November installment.' A document cannot refer to its own future publication history. The June letter independently shows Poe reasoning from Philadelphia through press arguments; it does not by itself prove where Poe was in May.